KINGFISH ACE

Student guide · read the night before and the morning of

21A Maintenance Officer Intermediate Course · rules follow the Kingfish ACE rulebook (Lt Col Troy Pierce). C2IMERA reporting is not used.

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1 The mission and how you win



Mission: establish adaptive cluster operations using Agile Combat Employment (ACE) to set conditions for success in the Indo-Pacific. Disperse to survive, then mass effects in line with strategic intent.

- Each wing keeps **1 hub** (its home base) and opens **3 spokes**. Supplies usually stretch to bring **2 spokes to IOC**; keep the third as a backup you can move into fast.
- **Mission Points (MP)**: bring spokes to IOC, assess them, run combat turns and refueling, fly fighter sorties from your spokes.
- **Demoralization Points (DP)** count against you: every 5 DP costs 1 MP.
- **Resource Points (RP)**: 5 RP buys one supply chit.
- The projector shows each wing's score and the **class total**. A changed score glows gold.

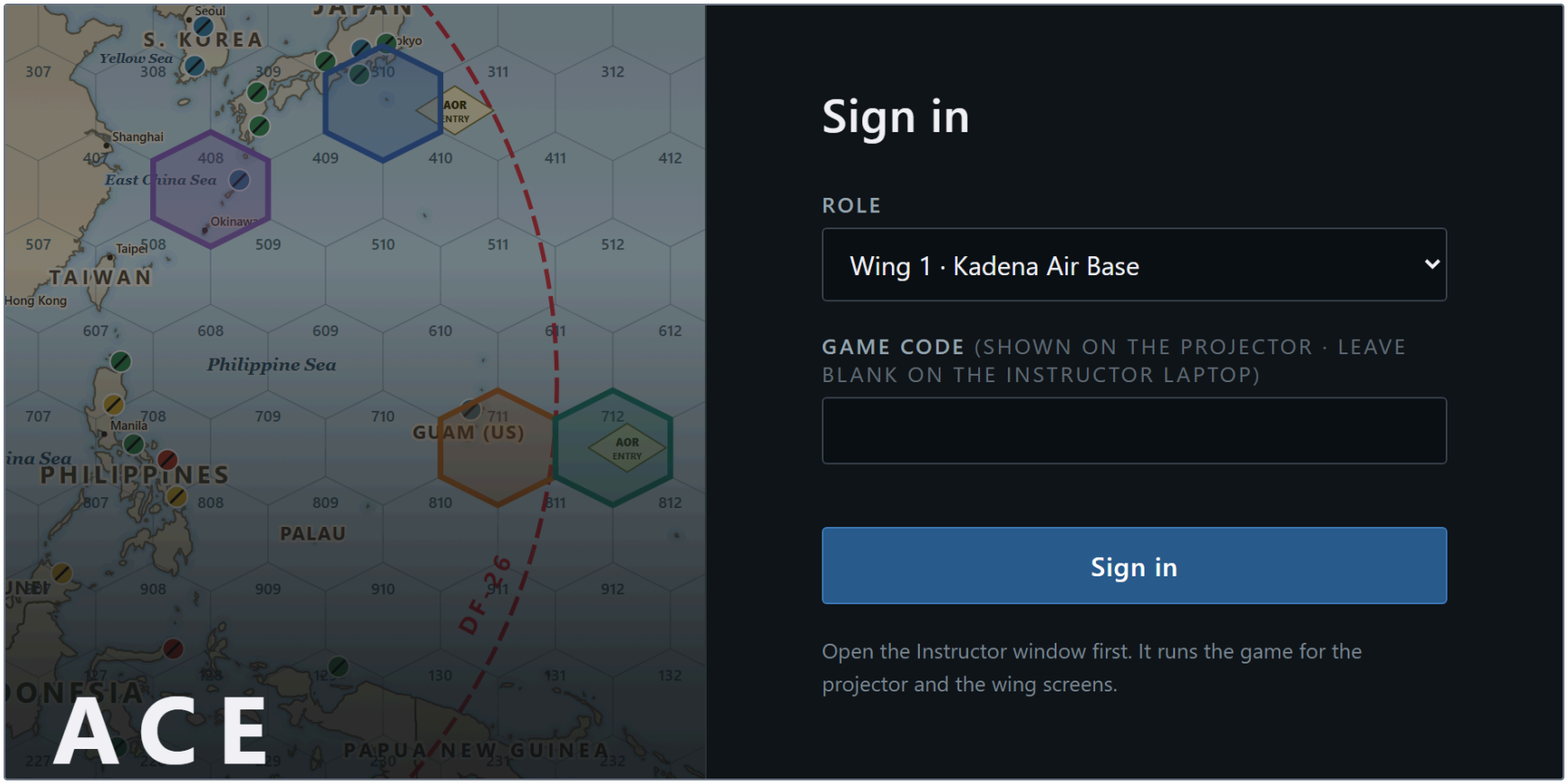
> **To win, each wing needs:** a score of **100** (Mission Points minus 1 per 5 Demoralization; a score never drops below 0), its **hub**, and at least **one spoke at IOC**. The class wins when every wing has all three. Your instructor can change the 100 in Game setup.

2 Your team and your wing

Wing	Home base (hub)	Fighters	What it is good at
Wing 1	Kadena Air Base, hex 408	16 F-15	Lead fighter wing, closest to the fight. Big munitions stocks, some missile defense. Light port, security and crash/fire rescue.
Wing 2	Andersen Air Force Base, hex 711	16 F-22	Large logistics and war reserve hub. Big munitions stocks, large security force and port.
Wing 3	Joint Base Pearl Harbor-Hickam (enters at 712)	16 F-22	Fighters plus a prepositioned Contingency Response Group: extra port, comms and security. No exportable missile defense.
Wing 4	Yokota Air Base, hex 310 (F-16s at Misawa, 210)	16 F-16	Mobility hub with extra port, comms and bed-down. Fighter support sits at Misawa.

Roles in each wing: a **Commander** (lead planner), a **Port** team (load plans and aircraft) and an **Airfield** team (RFIs, tasks, base status). Talk through the Commander once your people leave home station.

3 Signing in



1. Open Kingfish ACE in **Microsoft Edge**. Your instructor sets up each wing screen.
2. Under **Role**, pick your wing (Wing 1 to Wing 4). Wings have no password.
3. Press **Sign in**.

- Two views at the top of your screen: **Hex map** and **Resources**.
- Tabs on the right: **Plan** (named **Bases** once turn 1 starts), **Airlift**, **Fighters** (from turn 1) and **Comms**.

> Your screen shows only your wing. The instructor window must be open for the game to run. When you press **Roll**, the dice tumble on your screen and land on the result.

4 Reading the map

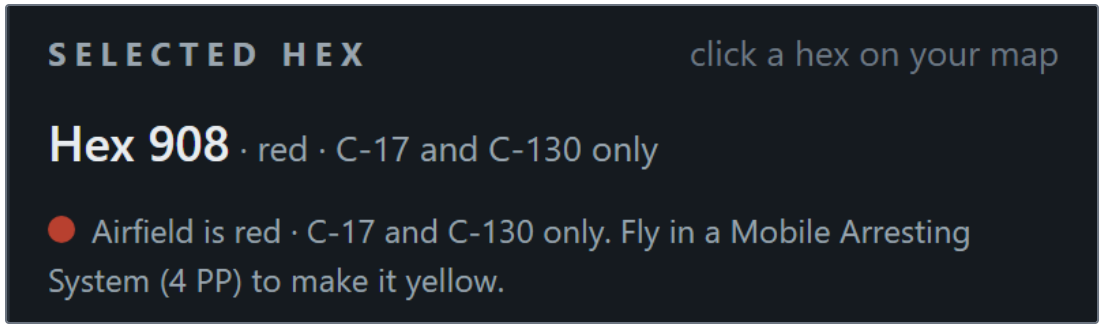


- Each hex is about **200 nautical miles** and has a number (for example 607).
- **Airfield dots:**
  green = day and night, all aircraft
  yellow = day only
  red = C-17 and C-130 only
  blue = main operating base
- A hex can hold more than one airfield.
- The dashed red circle is the **DF-26 ring**. Inside it, airfields can be hit by ballistic missiles in a conflict.
- Your bases show in your wing color: your **hub is a solid hex**, each **spoke is an outlined hex**. Click a base to see its name.
- Aircraft sitting at a base show as small badges with a count (for example a C-17 badge with 2). They fly their routes as the timer runs.

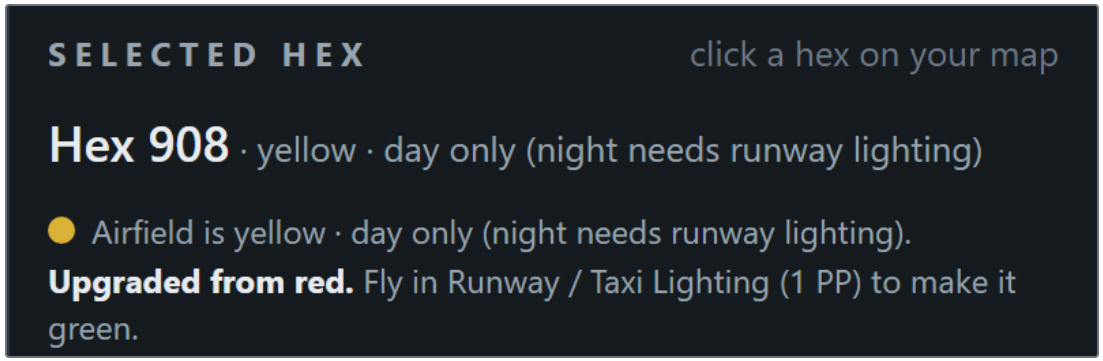
> Country borders matter: each day a country may grant or deny base access and overflight.

5 Upgrading a red or yellow airfield

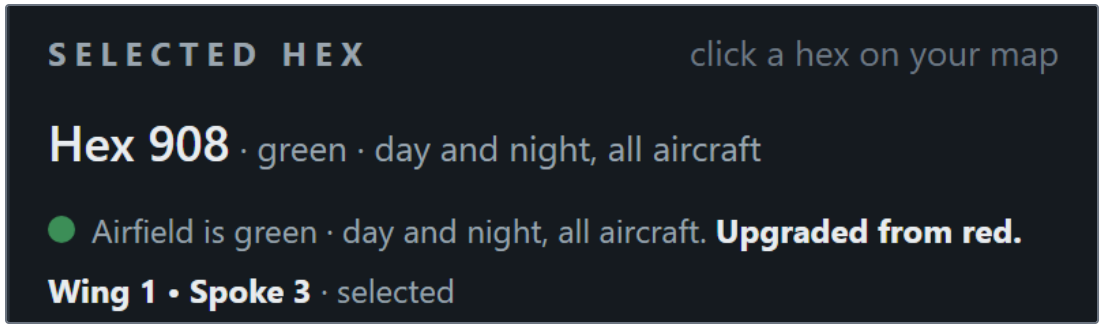
1. A red airfield as chosen



2. Mobile Arresting System on site



3. Runway / Taxi Lighting also on site



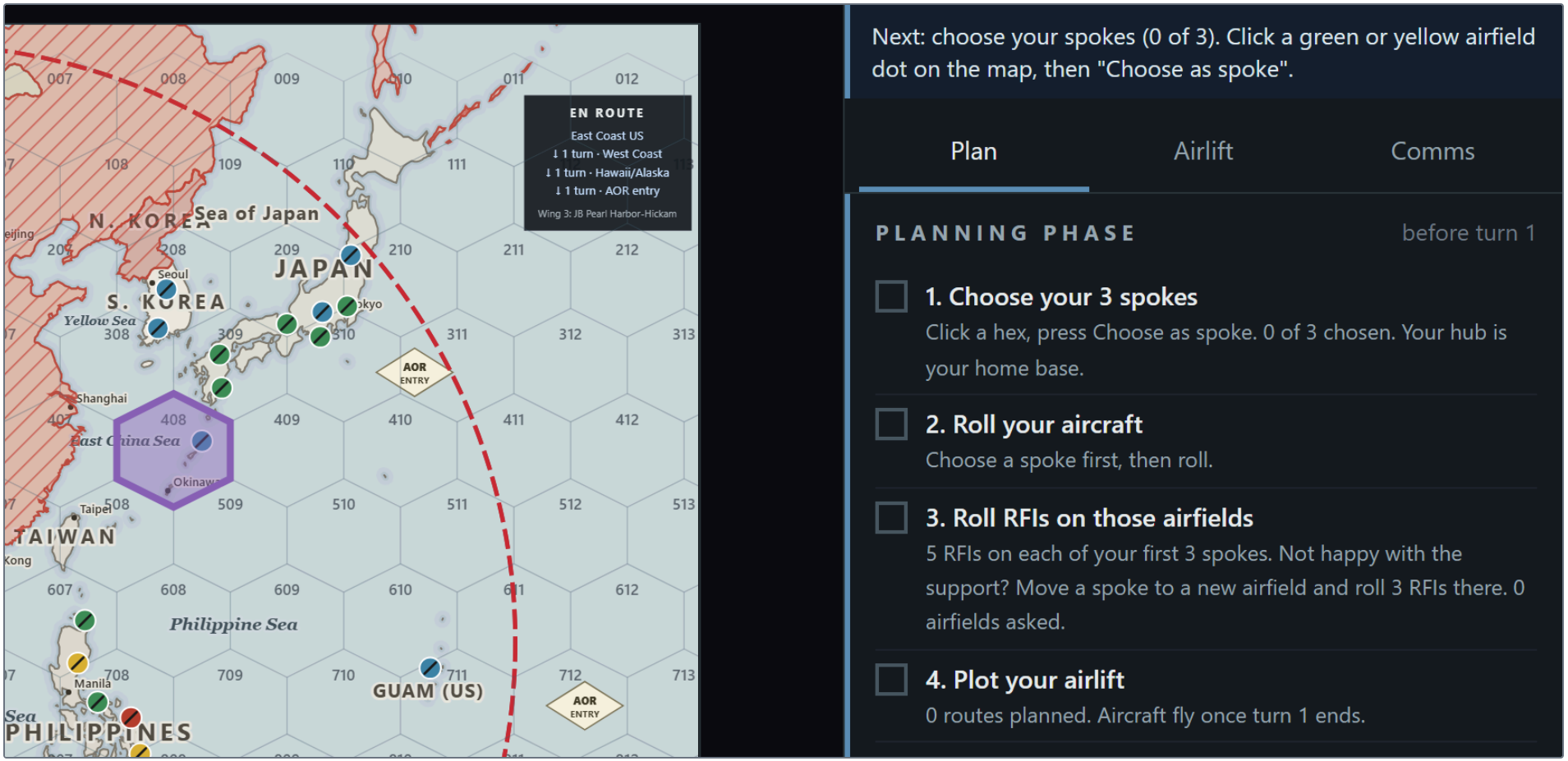
Airfield	Fly in	Becomes
red C-17 and C-130 only	Mobile Arresting System **4 PP**	**yellow** day only
yellow day only	Runway / Taxi Lighting **1 PP**	**green** day and night, all aircraft

1. Load the chip at your home station. Both are under **Mission Generation** in the load plan.
2. Fly it to the airfield. The color changes when the chip is on site.
3. Click the base. The panel and the Resources page state the current color and what is still needed.

> A red airfield needs both chips to reach green. The upgrade holds only while the chip stays on site.

Rulebook: airfield playing cards, page 11

6 The planning phase

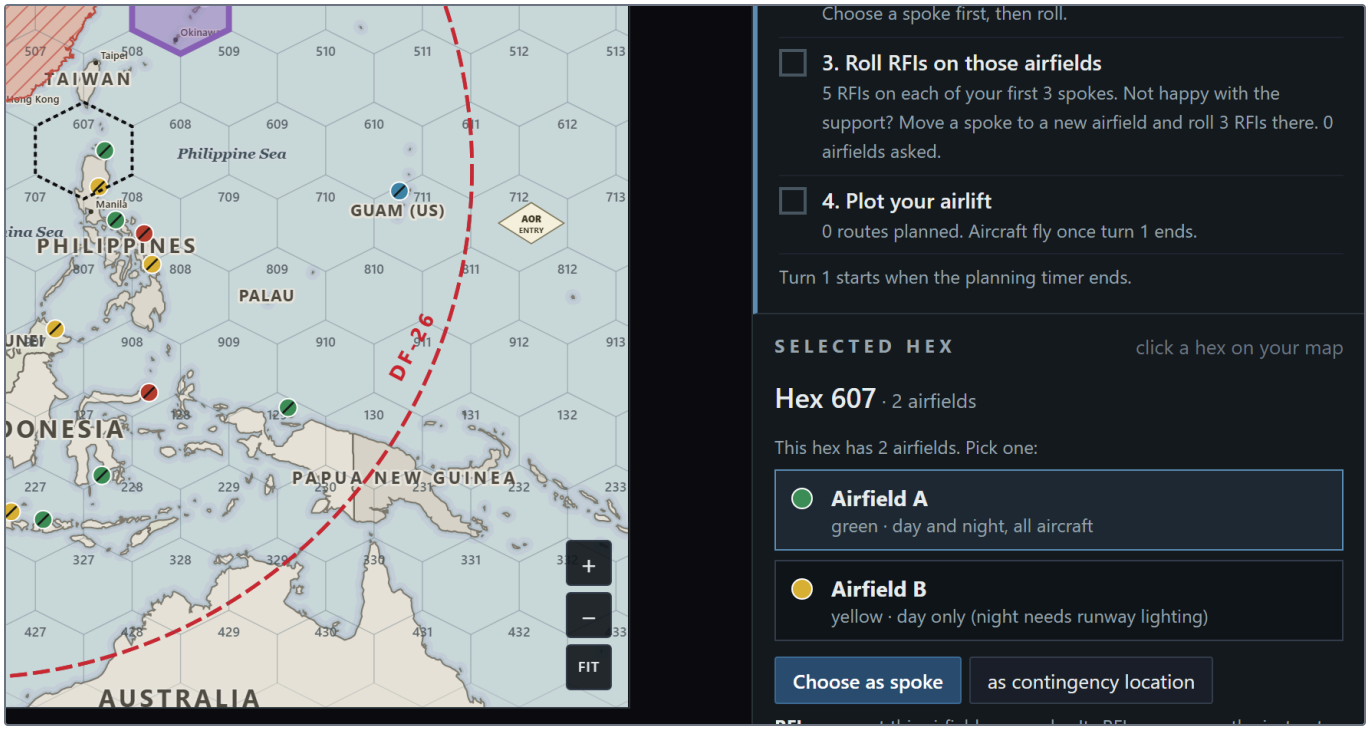


Before turn 1 you get a **planning timer** (30 minutes unless your instructor sets another). The checklist on the **Plan** tab walks you through it.

1. Wait for the day's **base access** roll. It shows on the projector and decides which countries let you in.
2. Choose your 3 spokes.
3. Roll your aircraft. The button turns on once you have chosen a spoke.
4. Roll RFIs on those airfields.
5. Plot your airlift.

> Nothing is assigned for you. You make every choice. Turn 1 starts when the planning timer ends.

7 Choosing your 3 spokes



1. Wait for the base access roll. Spoke requests are refused until it has been rolled.
2. Click an airfield hex on your map. Spokes cannot sit in a Mission area hex.
3. If the hex has more than one airfield, pick **Airfield A**, **B** or **C**. Each shows its color.
4. Press **Choose as spoke** (or **as contingency location**).
5. The instructor approves it (with automatic turns on, it is approved at once). It appears on the board as an outlined hex in your wing color.

- Your hub never moves. It is your home base.
- To move a spoke later, click the new airfield and press **move a spoke here**. You can ask any time; the move happens at the end of the turn.
- Chips you flew into the old spoke stay there until you fly them out.

Rulebook: select airfields, page 8

8 Rolling your aircraft



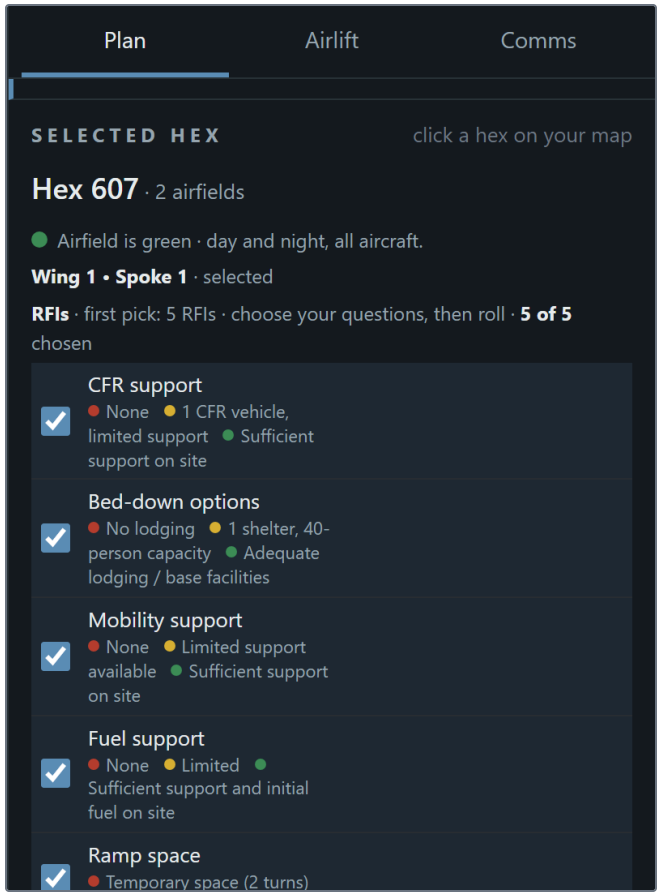
- Choose a spoke first. Then press **Roll aircraft**.
- Each day your wing rolls its own airlift: **C-17 on a D12**, **C-130 on a D12**, **C-5 on a D4**.
- The **Airlift** tab shows each aircraft as a **chalk**, numbered within its type: C-17 Chalk 1, C-17 Chalk 2, and so on.
- The number on the right shows how many are free, for example **7 of 7 free**.
- Under each chalk you see where it is: **at Hub**, **en route to** a spoke, or at a spoke.
- A chalk reads **empty** until you load it. A faded aircraft is already flying.
- An aircraft still in the air at the day change finishes its trip, then goes back. It does not count against the next day.

Aircraft	Cargo only	Mixed	People only	Moves
C-17	18 PP	11 PP + 54	102	4 hexes/turn
C-130	8 PP	2 PP + 62	128	3 hexes/turn
C-5	36 PP + 73		328	4 hexes/turn

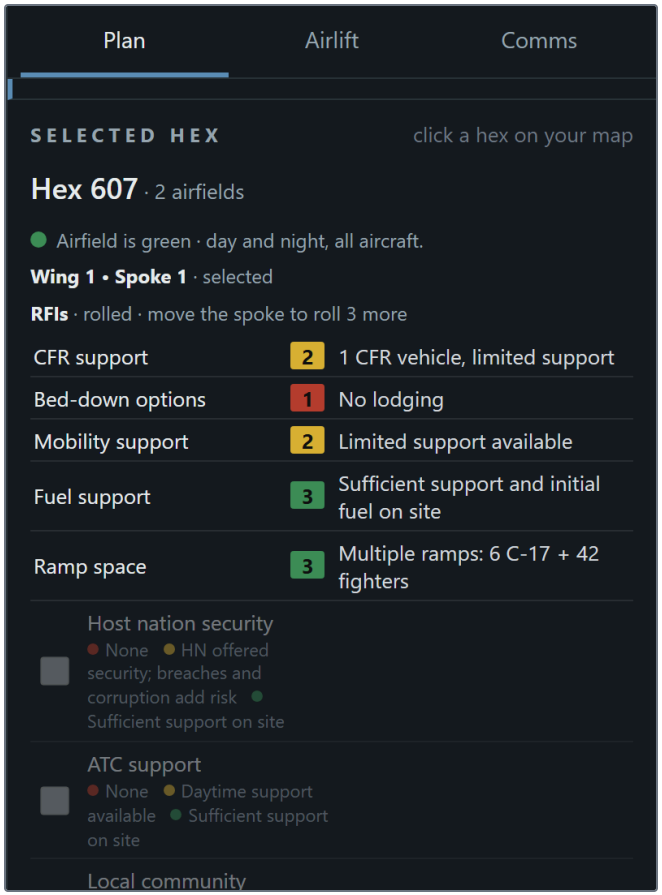
Rulebook: daily aircraft allocation and load aircraft, pages 8–9

9 RFIs: pick, then roll

1. Check your questions



2. Answers after the roll

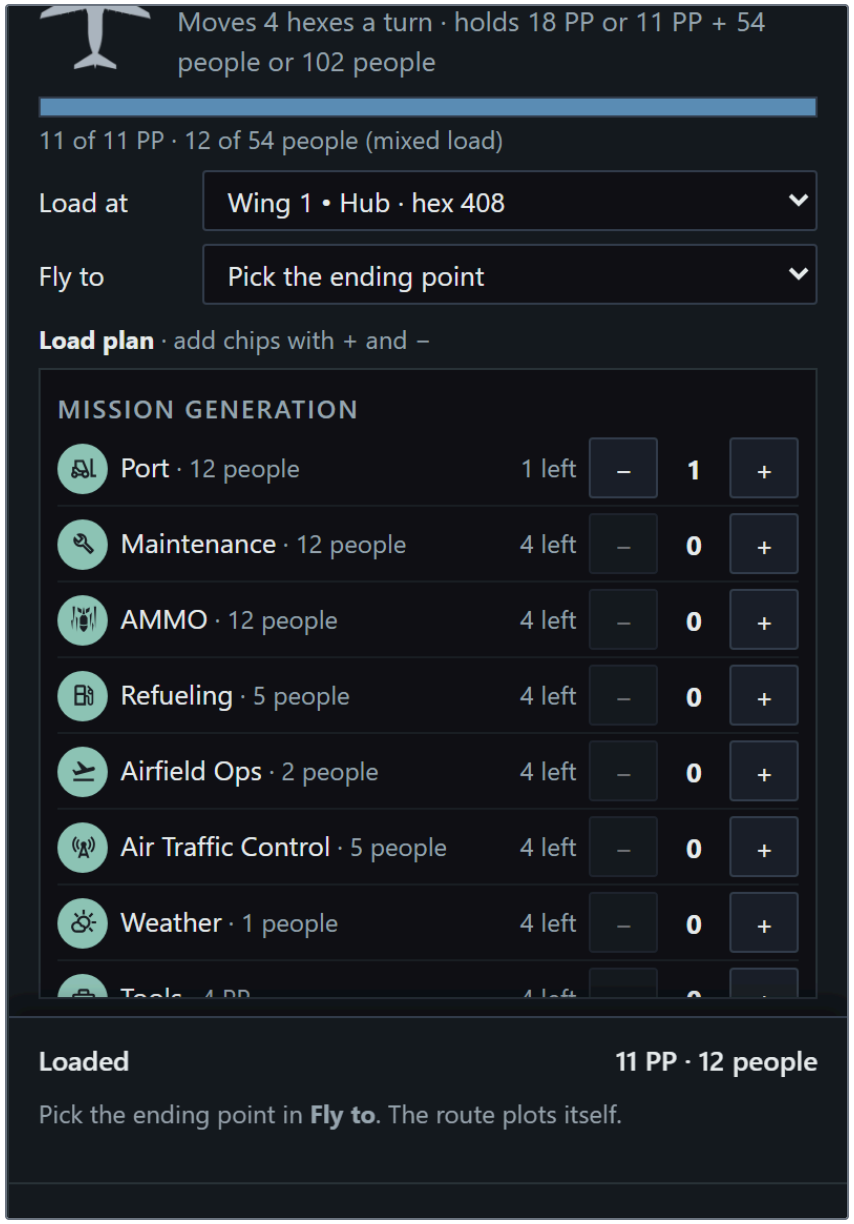


1. Click the airfield. Check up to **5 RFI questions**. If you chose to move a spoke there, you get **3**. If you were **forced** to move (airspace closed or access denied), you get **5**.
2. Press **Roll selected RFIs**. Each gets a D4.

Answer	Means
1	No support. You must bring it.
2	Partial support (for example 1 tent, 1 fuel truck).
3	Full support. Some 3s complete tasks for you.

Host nation support from your answers loads onto that base as chips. The **Ramp space** answer sets how many aircraft fit (1 C-130 / 2 C-17 / 6 C-17). When your people land, you can ask all remaining RFIs.

10 Load plans: one chalk at a time



1. On the **Airlift** tab, click one aircraft. The load plan opens for that chalk (for example **C-17 Chalk 1**).
2. Under **Load at**, pick the base you are loading from.
3. Add people, equipment and supplies with **+** and **−**.
4. Under **Fly to**, pick the destination. Check the **Loaded** total.

- The bar and the line under it show pallet positions (PP) and people used, for example **11 of 11 PP · 12 of 54 people**.
- Every chip shows its size (people per team, or PP for equipment and supplies) and how many are left at that base.
- If the aircraft is full, it tells you it is at **max capacity**.
- Chips working on a task cannot be loaded until you pull them off the task.

11 Plotting routes and moving

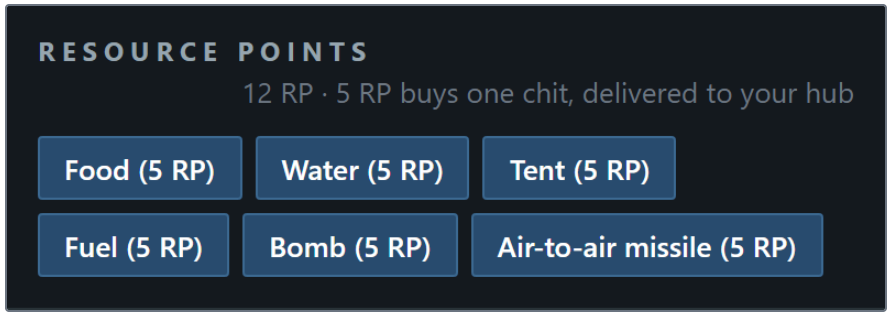


1. In the load plan, pick the destination under **Fly to**.
2. The route plots itself from the base you loaded at, around closed airspace. It shows on the map as a dotted line.
3. Read the checks under the route. When each line says **OK**, press **Launch**.

- A close trip takes 1 turn. A far one takes 2 or 3.
- The aircraft flies its route on the board while the shift timer runs.
- The cargo lands at the end of the turn it arrives.

> The program blocks: an overloaded aircraft, a C-5 into a red field, more aircraft than you rolled, a full ramp (max on ground) and a struck airfield.

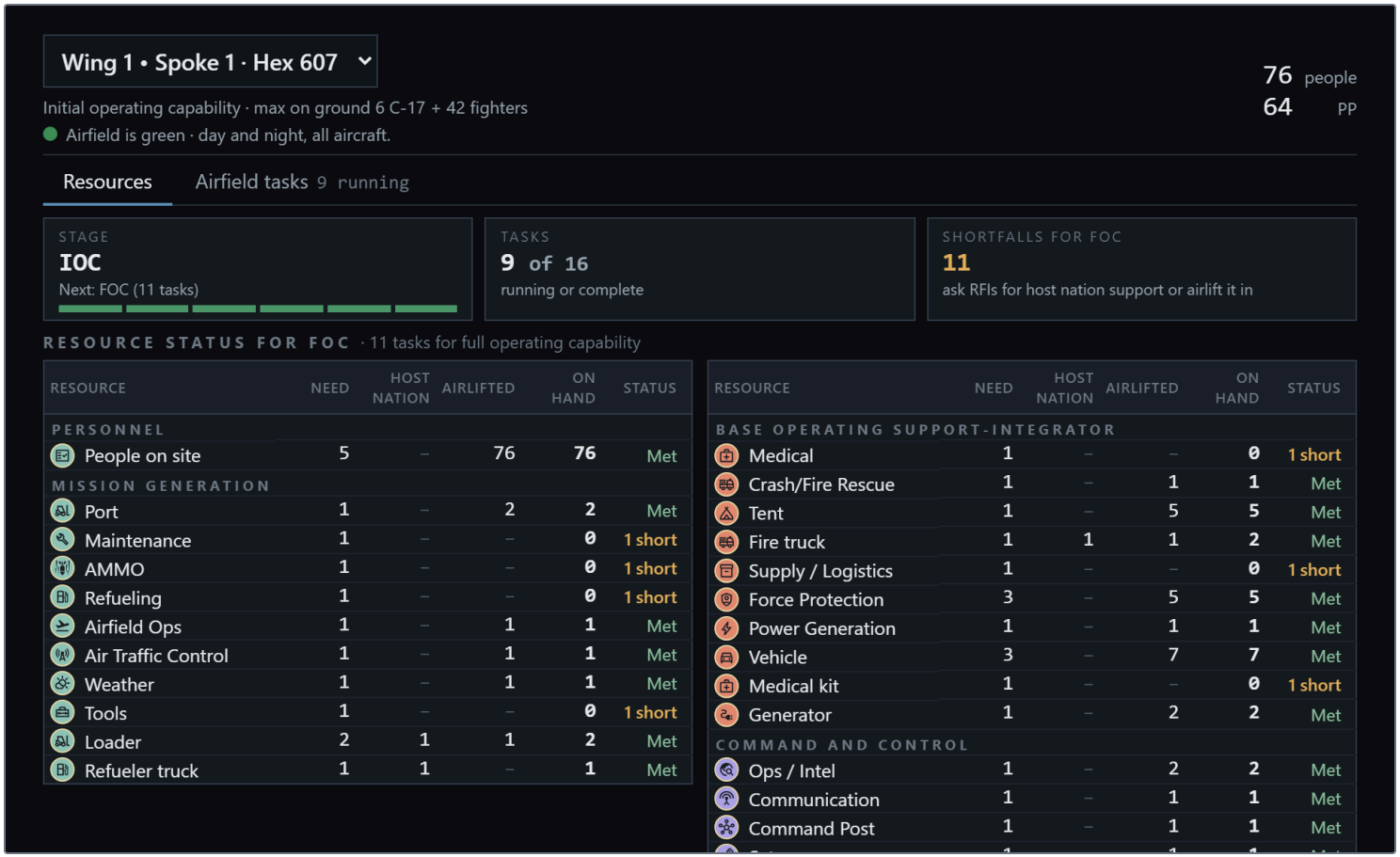
12 Resource Points: buying supplies



1. Open the **Bases** tab. The **Resource Points** panel shows your balance.
2. With 5 RP or more, press a button: **Food**, **Water**, **Tent**, **Fuel**, **Bomb** or **Air-to-air missile**.
3. The chit appears at your hub, ready to load.

- You earn **1 RP every turn** that task 13, host nation relationships, runs at one of your airfields.
- There is no request form. What you have is what you started with, what host nations give you, and what you buy.
- **Conflict resupply:** each conflict day, every hub receives 4 bombs and 4 air-to-air missiles.
- **Headquarters help:** with automatic turns on, each day your hub may receive up to 2 items your spokes are missing for IOC. The Comms tab tells you what arrived.

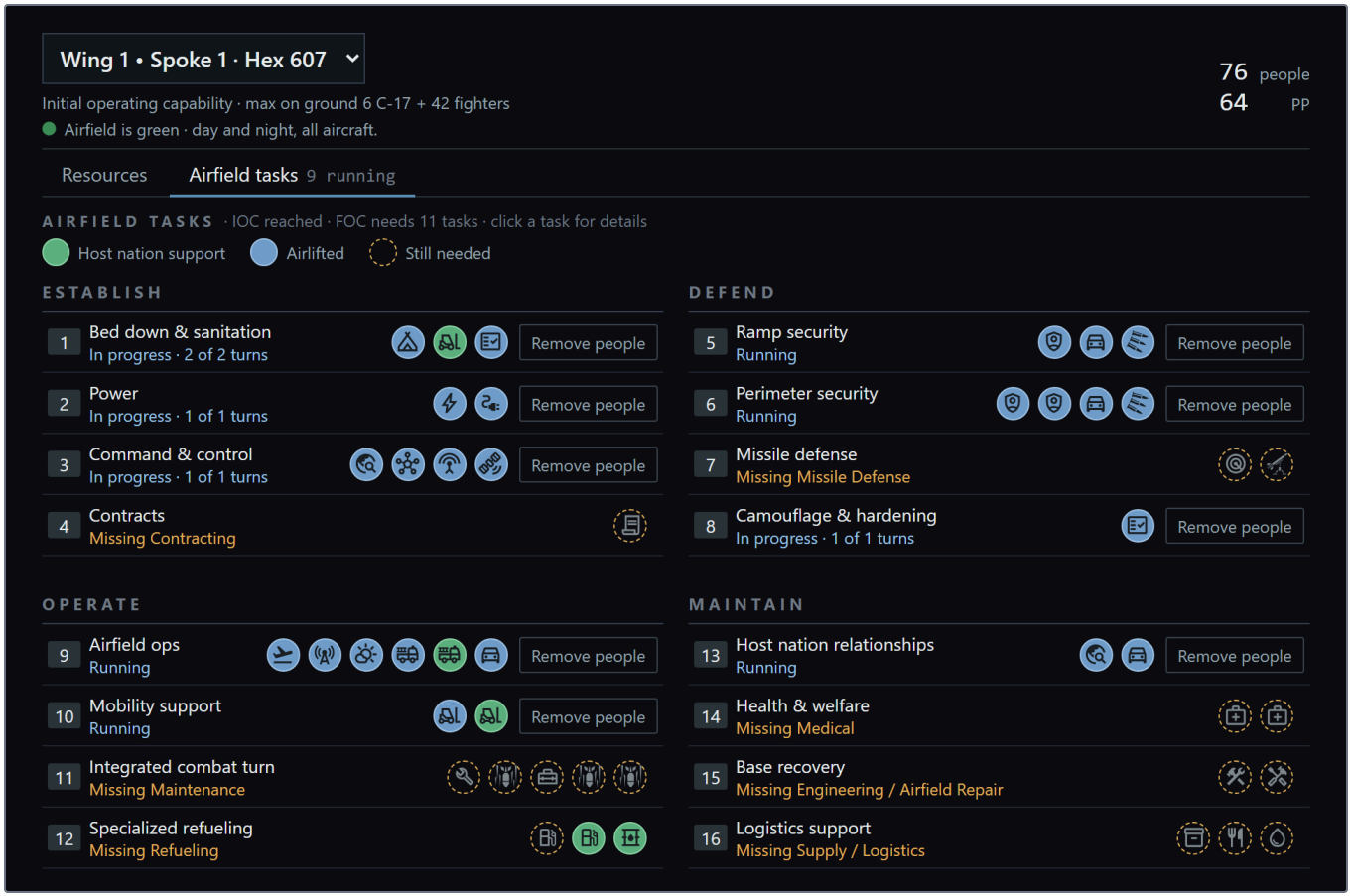
13 The Resources page



- Open **Resources** at the top of the screen. Pick a base from the dropdown (for example **Wing 1 • Spoke 1 · Hex 607**).
- The header shows the stage, max on ground, the airfield color, and people and PP on site.
- Three boxes: **Stage**, **Tasks** running, and **Shortfalls** for the next milestone.
- The two-column table lists every resource: **Need**, **Host nation** (from your RFI answers), **Airlifted**, **On hand** and **Status** (Met, or how many short).
- Cargo appears under Airlifted at the end of the turn the aircraft lands.

> A chip works one task at a time. If one Vehicle is on Ramp security, Airfield ops still shows a Vehicle short. Use **Take from task** on the Airfield tasks tab to move it.

14 Airfield tasks, IOC and FOC



- On the Resources page, open the **Airfield tasks** tab. The 16 tasks sit in four groups: Establish, Defend, Operate, Maintain.
- Chips: **green** = host nation support · **blue** = airlifted · **dashed outline** = still needed.
- **Ready**: press **Assign people**.
- **In progress** or **Running**: press **Remove people** to free them.
- **Missing**: names the chip you need.
- **Take from task N**: the chip is busy on another task at this base. One click stops that task (its progress is kept) and starts this one.
- **Host nation**: an RFI answer covers the task in full.
- The **IOC** tag marks the 5 tasks IOC needs.

Milestone	Tasks
IOC	1 Bed down, 2 Power, 3 Command and control, 5 Ramp security, 9 Airfield ops
FOC	11 tasks: 1, 2, 3, 5, 6, 9, 10, 11, 12, 14 and 16

Reaching IOC gives **+5 MP** for that spoke. **Integrated combat turn** and **Specialized refueling** each give **+5 MP every turn** they run. Fighters can launch only from a spoke running both.

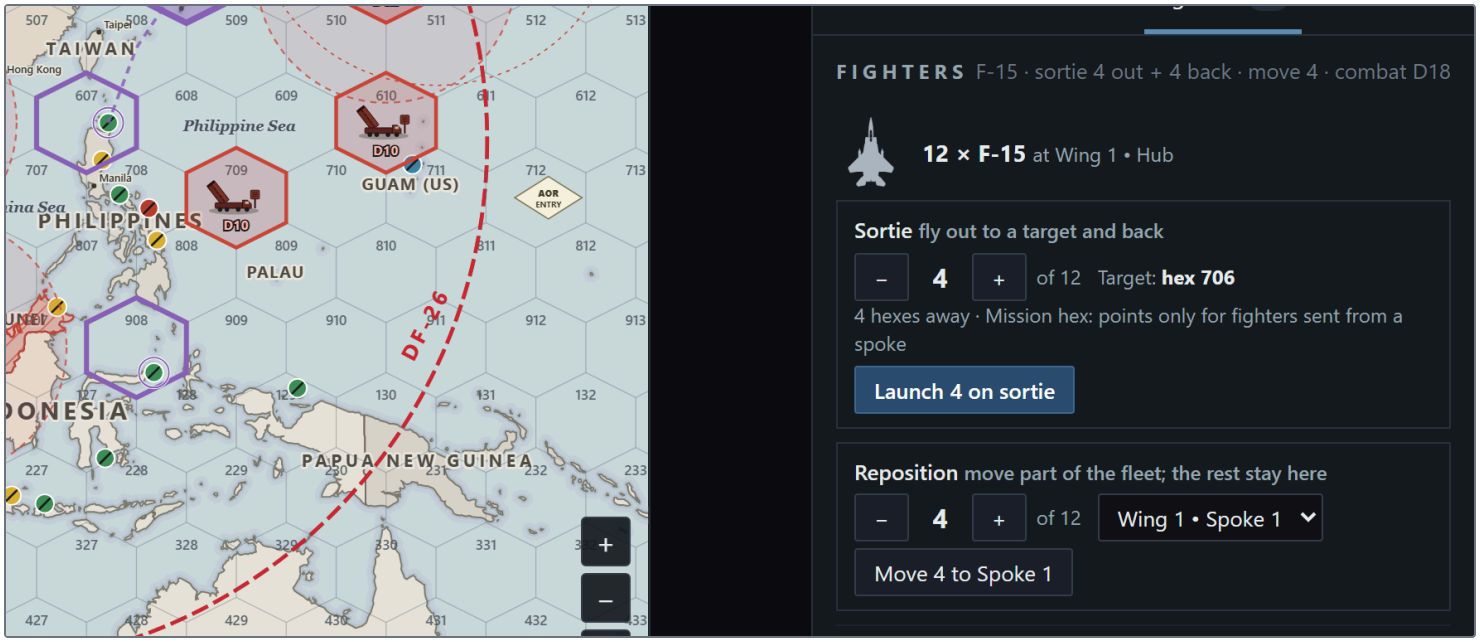
15 Food, water, fuel and morale

Rule	What happens
Logistics tax	At the start of each game day, every airfield with your people pays 1 food, 1 water, 1 fuel: every day with 50+ people, every other day with fewer. Home bases are exempt.
No food or water	10 DP the first day, 30 DP every day after. No DP at a struck airfield.
Too many people	Twice as many people as tasks use: roll D4 for DP. Three times: roll D10. Not checked at a struck airfield or where people landed that turn. At most 10 DP per wing per turn.
Competing priorities	A daily D10: below 5 you lose comms, a commodity, a host nation chip, or port support for a turn.

> Keep flying food, water and fuel forward. Put every person you deploy to work on a task.

Rulebook: pages 6 and 12; scenario card

16 Fighters: crisis and conflict



- Open the **Fighters** tab.
- **Reposition**: pick a base and a number. Fighters move up to 4 hexes and fly there on the board during the turn. The Ramp space RFI limits fighters on the ground (2, 7 or 42).
- **Launch**: click the target hex on the map, then press Launch. The sortie flies out to the target and back on the board. The spoke must be running its combat turn and refueling.
- **+5 MP per fighter that flies** from a **spoke** into a Mission hex. Hub launches score nothing.
- Each wing scores **one 4-ship per Mission hex per turn**. To score more, send flights to different Mission hexes, or let another wing's spokes cover one.

	Crisis	Conflict
Munitions	Bombs and missiles reused	Each fighter uses 1 bomb + 1 air-to-air missile
Combat	None	Into a Red zone, one fighter at a time: your D18 vs the zone's die (D10, D12 or D20). Higher roll wins; a tie goes to Red. A losing fighter is shot down. The first win removes the zone and the rest fly home. A jammer nearby can add +2 to Red.

Rulebook: assign combat aircraft and resistance operations, pages 12–14

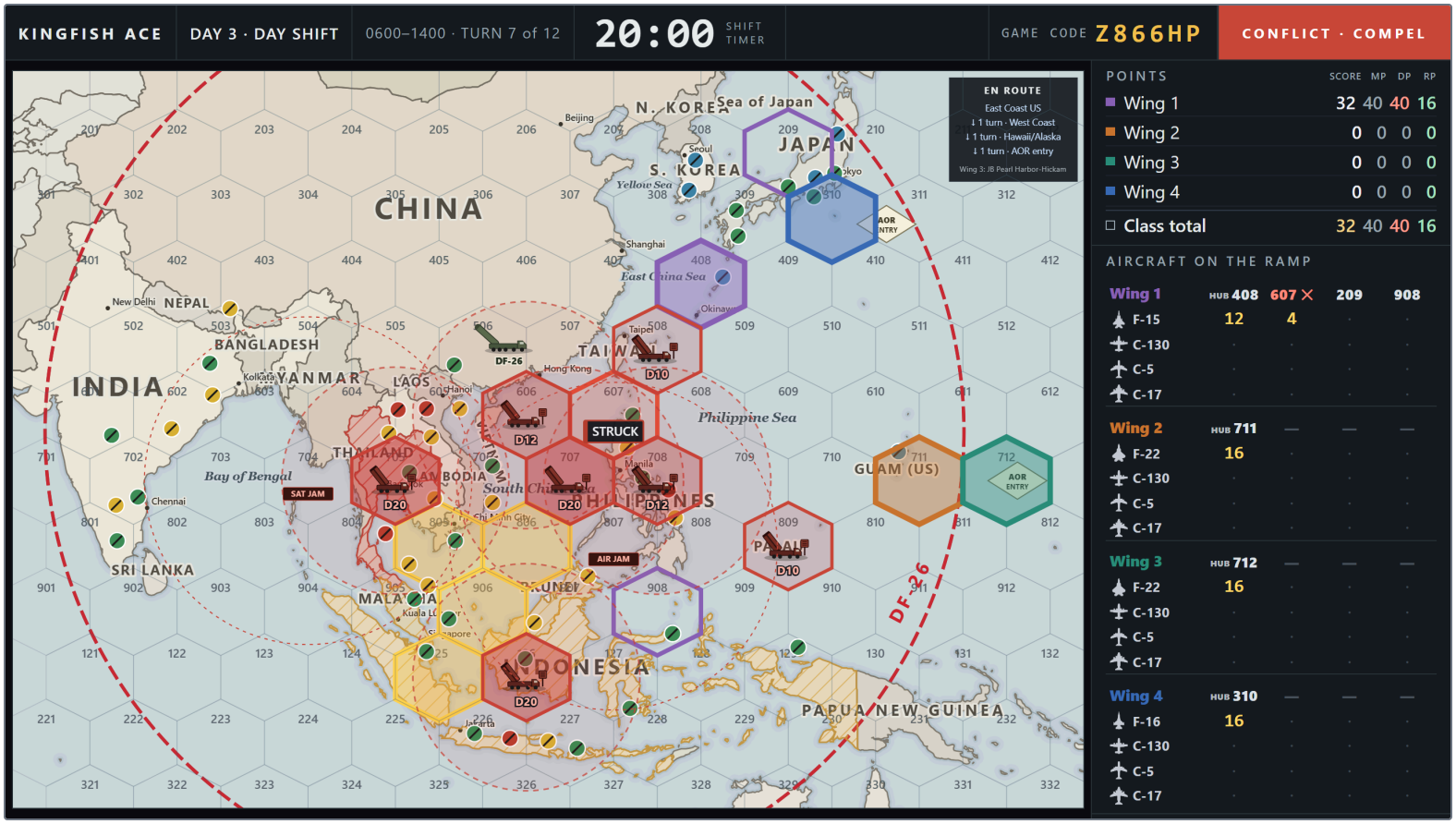
17 Situation, mission intent, risk tokens



- Each game day a **D12** decides crisis or conflict. Conflict gets more likely each day (Day 1: crisis on 1–10, Day 2: 1–8, Day 3+: 1–6). No conflict before turn 7 unless your instructor changes it.
- A **D4** picks the mission intent.
- With automatic turns on, these dice roll by themselves.
- The program marks **2 sets of 3 Mission hexes**. Only sorties into them earn MP.
- In a conflict the instructor places **6 Red zones** (2 Deep D20, 2 Air-land D12, 2 Farthest intercept D10) and 2 jammers.
- **Risk tokens** let your wing pitch an out-of-the-box move. Hand in one per activity.

Crisis	Tokens	Conflict	Tokens
Observe	0	Deter	1
Assure	0	Subdue	2
Shape	1	Compel	3
Persuade	2	Eradicate	4

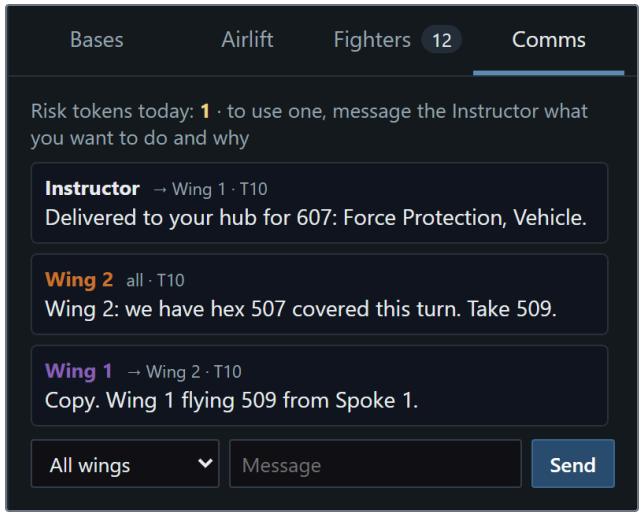
18 Conflict: how Red attacks



1. **Target:** each conflict turn, Red picks **one airfield per wing at random** from your bases inside the DF-26 ring. Your hub can be picked.
2. **Information attack** on that airfield: a D10. Jamming (a Red jammer within 2 hexes, roll above 3) or cyber (roll above 7) cuts your comms for a turn.
3. **Missile attack:** Red's D20 rolls by itself; **your wing rolls its own D10** on its screen. Missile defense +2, hardening +1. A tie is defended.

- A hit on a **spoke** closes it until **Base recovery** (task 15: engineering team + airfield repair kit, 3 turns) is done. Aircraft cannot leave a struck airfield.
- A second hit restarts recovery. A **third hit destroys everything** on the spoke.
- A hit on your **hub** closes it for 3 turns. A hub is never destroyed.
- Aircraft flying to a struck airfield turn back with their cargo.
- There is no forced evacuation. Staying risks the next strike; moving is your call.

19 Comms



- Open the **Comms** tab. Pick who gets it under **To**: one wing, all wings, or the instructor.
- Type the message and press **Send**. It arrives on the other screens at once.
- Headquarters notes (for example items sent to your hub) arrive here too.
- **JAMMED:** a jamming or cyber attack cuts your comms for a turn. A red bar reads **JAMMED · COMMS DOWN THIS TURN** and the tab shows ⚠.
- While jammed, nothing goes out and nothing comes in. A message to a jammed wing does not go through.
- A message to all wings skips any wing that is jammed.
- To use a **risk token**, message the Instructor what you want to do and why.

> Talk through your Commander. Coordinate with other wings on who covers which Mission hex: each wing scores only one 4-ship per hex per turn.

20 A turn, step by step

Step	Who	What happens
1. Shift timer (20 min unless the instructor sets another)	Wings	Pick and roll RFIs, load chalks, plot routes, staff tasks, reposition and launch fighters, buy supplies with RP, ask for spoke moves. Aircraft fly their routes as the timer runs.
2. 0:00, end of turn	Program	Aircraft land and offload, tasks progress, points post, morale checks, approved spoke moves happen. Each wing is told which airfield its event and risk cards hit; draw them from the decks.
3. Conflict only	Red, then wings	One missile attack per wing at a random airfield. Red's D20 rolls by itself; each wing rolls its D10 defense.
4. Turn card	Projector	Shows the next turn and shift. A new day also rolls base access, then the situation and mission intent.
5. Dice	Projector	Any dice roll on screen. Nothing moves while dice are up; the next timer starts a few seconds after they close.

> One turn = one 8-hour shift: Day (0600–1400), Swing (1400–2200), Mid (2200–0600). Each new game day also collects the logistics tax. With automatic turns off, the instructor runs steps 3 to 5 by hand.

21 Points cheat sheet

Mission Points (+)	MP
Spoke reaches IOC (tasks 1, 2, 3, 5, 9), first wing there	+5
Assess an airfield (vehicle + assessment team on site)	+5
Integrated combat turn running, each turn	+5
Specialized refueling running, each turn	+5
Each fighter that flies from a spoke into a Mission hex (one 4-ship per wing per hex per turn)	+5

Demoralization Points (−)	DP
A day without food or water (first day / each day after)	10 / 30
People 2× / 3× what the tasks use	D4 / D10

Score = MP − 1 for every 5 DP, never below 0. **Win** = each wing scores 100 and holds its hub plus one spoke at IOC. Host nation relationships (task 13): +1 RP per turn; 5 RP = one supply chit.

22 Your two days

When	What
Night before	Read this guide. Know your wing, how to win, and the planning checklist.
Morning of	Skim pages 6–11 again: planning, spokes, aircraft, RFIs, load plans, routes.
Day 1, first block	Watch the Kingfish ACE gameplay videos (the board game).
Day 1, next	Watch the Kingfish ACE program demo video (this software).
Day 1, setup (1 hour)	Sign in, then the planning phase: choose spokes, roll aircraft, roll RFIs, build load plans, plot first routes.
Game play	Turns of 20 minutes each unless your instructor sets another. At 0:00 the game moves to the next turn on its own. In a conflict, roll your missile defense when your screen asks.
End	Debrief: what you would change, and the attrition you would face in a real fight.

> Questions during play go to your Commander first, then the instructor.